



Proposed CEA Link — December 2026

How this rota would work from December 2026, and how it compares with today's link

Prepared 30 September 2026 · every figure is calculated from the rota, not entered by hand

PROPOSAL

Familiar Nine

No duty over nine hours, and most duties at times people already work

CODE **F9-24-K31s**

FINGERPRINT **598a1294**

SET AGAINST today's 20-week link

CREATED 28 September 2026

IN SHORT

Familiar Nine meets all 9 December staffing rules and stays inside every hard limit. For staff, the biggest gains are a full weekend off one in 4 weeks (today one in 5) and never more than 6 days in a row (today 9). The main trade-offs are more late finishes (about one extra every 2 or 3 weeks each) and the average shift 6 minutes longer.

For discussion, not a decision. This proposal has not yet been through the roster office or a union rep. Still to settle: which link is used — colleagues' views come first — and then who starts on which line; the rota does not say who works which week.

What it takes: 24 people, 4 more than today's 20 · 4 cover weeks for leave and sickness · 10 on duty every Sunday (today 8; the rules ask for 10) — 82h 30m of Sunday overtime across the whole link each week (today 68h 15m).

Can it work?

Does it meet the December staffing rules?

9 of 9

rules met

today's link meets 4 · each rule on page 6

Can it be run within the hard limits?

Yes

inside every hard limit

shortest gap 14h 20m (limit 12h) · most days in a row 6 (limit 13) · 35-hour contract exact

Any avoidable fatigue warnings?

0

none in the fixed duties

today's link has 5 · guidance, not a pass or fail · page 7

Does staffing follow the trains better?

Yes

closer than today on weekdays, Saturday and Sunday

weekdays 27.7 (today 52.0) · Sat 15.0 (65.9) · Sun 26.4 (71.7) · on weekdays about half as far off as today · page 5

What it would mean for staff

Likely positives for staff

- A full weekend off one in 4 weeks (today one in 5)
- Never more than 6 days in a row (today 9)
- About 2 fewer contracted days at work a year
- Shortest rest between shifts 14h 20m (today 12h 30m)
- No avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed duties (today 5)

More detail on page 2

What colleagues may be concerned about

- More late finishes — about one extra every 2 or 3 weeks each
- The average shift 6 minutes longer
- More 06:20 starts — about one extra every 17 or 18 weeks each
- 8 new shift times to learn

What changes, in numbers

Today's 20-week link beside Familiar Nine. ✓ **green**: better than today on something the rules, the hard limits or the fatigue guidance aim for · ▲ **amber**: worse on one of those · ✗ **red**: a rule or limit broken · **unshaded**: a difference for colleagues to weigh.

QUESTION	TODAY	FAMILIAR NINE	IN PLAIN WORDS
STAFFING			
People on the link	20	24	4 more people, one per line
On duty each day — weekday · Saturday · Sunday	11·12 · 10 · 8	✓ 14 · 14 · 10	the December levels ask for 10 on a Sunday — met
On at the open — weekday · Sat · Sun	4 · 4 · 3	✓ 5 · 5 · 4	at least 4 every day — met
Still on duty at 22:00 — weekday · Sat · Sun	4 · 2 · 3	✓ 6 · 5 · 5	at least 5 every day — met
Through to the close — weekday · Sat · Sun	2 · 2 · 3	✓ 3 · 4 · 3	at least 3 every day — met
How closely staff follow the trains — weekday · Sat · Sun	52.0 · 65.9 · 71.7	✓ 27.7 · 15.0 · 26.4	lower is closer — on weekdays about half as far off as today; page 5
Cover weeks — for leave and sickness	lines 1, 7, 12, 17	lines 1, 7, 13, 19	evenly spaced — one week in 6
Ticket office late shift on a Sunday — people	1	2	the December plan: both in the office 15:00–18:00, then one on the floor; today one 14:30–23:25 closer keeps it until 22:30
WORKING PATTERN			
Most days worked in a row	9	✓ 6	Chiltern's limit is 13 (written source to confirm)
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h 30m	✓ 14h 20m	the limit is 12 hours
Full weekends off	4 in 20	✓ 6 in 24	one in 4 weeks, against one in 5 today
Days at work a year, not counting Sundays	219	217	Sundays are overtime; a cover week counts as 4 days
Weeks on one shift time	7 of 16	14 of 20	all earlies or all lates, one clock time Monday to Friday
Weeks mixing earlies and lates	7 of 16	3 of 20	a week with both early and late shifts in it
Single rest days	4	2	a rest day on its own — not a two-day break
Six-day weeks	1	0	weeks with six days at work, a Sunday included
SHIFTS			
Average shift · longest shift	8h 14m · 9h 10m	8h 20m · 9h 00m	the average is Monday to Saturday; the longest is on any day
Early shifts, shortest to longest	7h 15m–8h 30m	7h 15m–9h 00m	an early starts before 11:00 · any day of the week
Late shifts, shortest to longest	7h 30m–9h 10m	7h 30m–8h 55m	a late starts at 11:00 or after · any day of the week
Closing shift — weekday · Sat · Sun	8h 40m · 9h 10m · 8h 55m	✓ 8h 10m · 8h 40m · 8h 10m	the shift that locks up
How far the start time moves from one week to the next — on average	4h 00m	✓ 1h 44m	smaller is easier on the body clock
Different shift times	18	✓ 16 (8 worked today)	8 new to learn, on 16 of the 20 working weeks — listed on page 4
EACH PERSON'S YEAR, ON AVERAGE			
Finishing at 23:00 or later	39	59	about one extra every 2 or 3 weeks
Starting at 06:20, the open	62	65	about one extra every 17 or 18 weeks
Saturdays worked	26	30	a rostered Saturday is paid at time and a quarter; cover weeks not counted
Sunday overtime to share	21	22	Sundays are overtime, as today
FATIGUE AND THE RULES			
Avoidable fatigue warnings (ORR and rail-industry guidance)	5	✓ 0	guidance, not a pass or fail; early starts and a weekly rotation come with every link — page 7
December staffing rules met	4 of 9	✓ 9 of 9	staffing levels confirmed 29 Sep 2026 — page 6

The workings: the rota (page 3) · shift times (4) · staffing through the day (5) · the rules (6) · fatigue checks (7) · can I trust these numbers? (8)

The 24-line link

Sunday to Saturday per line; everyone moves down one line each week and line 24 goes back to line 1. Hours and days at the right; the number on duty each day beneath.

20 working weeks · 4 cover weeks · 35h 00m a week on average · at most 6 days in a row · 14 weeks on one shift time

LINE	SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	MON-SAT hours	ALL WEEK hours	DAYS WORKED Mon-Sat	TURNS Mon-Fri
1	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	35h 00m	35h 00m	—	—
2	14:30 22:30	14:30 23:25	RD	RD	06:20 14:20	07:00 16:00	06:20 15:00	34h 35m	42h 35m	4	3
3	07:15 15:30	06:20 14:20	RD	RD	06:20 14:20	06:20 14:20	06:20 15:00	32h 40m	40h 55m	4	1
4	RD	RD	06:20 14:50	07:00 16:00	06:20 16:00	06:20 13:35	06:20 15:00	40h 40m	40h 40m	5	3
5	RD	RD	07:00 16:00	07:00 16:00	07:00 16:00	07:00 16:00	RD	36h 00m	36h 00m	4	1
6	RD	06:20 14:20	06:20 14:20	06:20 14:20	RD	RD	07:30 16:30	33h 00m	33h 00m	4	1
7	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	35h 00m	35h 00m	—	—
8	14:30 22:30	14:00 22:30	RD	RD	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	RD	25h 30m	33h 30m	3	1
9	RD	07:00 16:00	06:20 13:35	06:20 14:50	06:20 14:50	06:20 14:20	RD	41h 15m	41h 15m	5	4
10	RD	06:20 13:35	07:00 16:00	06:20 14:20	07:00 16:00	RD	06:20 14:50	41h 45m	41h 45m	5	3
11	07:15 15:30	06:20 14:50	06:20 14:50	RD	RD	06:20 14:50	07:30 16:30	34h 30m	42h 45m	4	1
12	07:15 15:30	06:20 14:50	06:20 14:20	06:20 13:35	RD	RD	15:15 23:55	32h 25m	40h 40m	4	3
13	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	35h 00m	35h 00m	—	—
14	07:15 15:30	07:00 16:00	RD	RD	15:45 23:55	15:45 23:55	15:15 23:55	34h 00m	42h 15m	4	2
15	RD	RD	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	14:30 22:00	41h 30m	41h 30m	5	1
16	15:15 23:25	RD	RD	15:45 23:55	15:45 23:55	15:45 23:55	RD	24h 30m	32h 40m	3	1
17	RD	15:45 23:55	15:45 23:55	15:45 23:55	15:45 23:55	RD	14:30 22:00	40h 10m	40h 10m	5	1
18	15:15 23:25	15:45 23:55	15:45 23:55	RD	RD	15:45 23:55	15:15 23:55	33h 10m	41h 20m	4	1
19	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	SP	35h 00m	35h 00m	—	—
20	09:00 18:00	RD	RD	06:20 14:50	06:20 14:50	06:20 14:50	06:20 14:50	34h 00m	43h 00m	4	1
21	RD	RD	14:30 23:25	14:30 23:25	14:30 23:25	14:30 23:25	RD	35h 40m	35h 40m	4	1
22	RD	13:30 21:00	13:30 21:00	13:30 21:00	13:30 21:00	13:30 21:00	RD	37h 30m	37h 30m	5	1
23	RD	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	14:00 22:30	RD	RD	15:15 23:55	34h 10m	34h 10m	4	1
24	15:15 23:25	15:45 23:55	15:45 23:55	15:45 23:55	RD	RD	14:00 22:30	33h 00m	41h 10m	4	1
On duty	10 SP 4	14 SP 4	14 SP 4	14 SP 4	14 SP 4	14 SP 4	14 SP 4	35h 00m	38h 26m	4.20	14 one-turn weeks
Minutes	4,950	6,970	6,970	6,970	6,970	6,970	7,150	42,000	46,950		

Early turns Late turns Cover (spare) week — four duties of seven, any turn Rest day

Mon-Sat hours average 35h 00m over 24 lines, a cover week counted as a contracted week · days worked average over the 20 working lines · Turns: how many different shift times the week works Monday to Friday; **bold** marks a one-turn week (see below) · Minutes: total duty minutes each day — Monday to Saturday adds up to the contract (35 hours for each of the 20 working weeks = 42,000 minutes)

The words on this page

Link — the whole rota: 24 weeks laid out as 24 lines. Everyone works line 1, then line 2, and so on round the wheel; the link needs 24 people.

Line — one week of the pattern, Sunday to Saturday. Everyone moves down a line each week, and line 24 goes back to line 1.

Turn — a shift time, such as 06:20-13:35. An **early** starts before 11:00; a **late** starts at 11:00 or later.

Rest day (RD) — a day off inside the contracted week. Two together make a proper break; one on its own does not count as a 48-hour break.

Cover (spare) week — a week with no fixed times. Whoever is on it works four duties of the seven days, placed by the roster clerk to cover leave and sickness.

Sunday — not part of the contract. A Sunday duty is rest-day working, paid on top of the week, which is why the hours are shown Mon-Sat and all week.

The contract — 35 hours a week, averaged over the 24 lines; a cover week counts as a full contracted week.

One-turn week — one clock time Monday to Friday, with every day of the week an early or every day a late (shown bold in the Turns column); the easiest kind of week to live around.

The floor — staff out on the station (gates, concourse, platforms); the ticket office joins it only at the quiet ends (page 5).

Opener / closer — the first people on duty in the morning and the last at night.

Shift times

The shift times staff would need to learn, every shift time beside the ones worked today, and the shape of a working week.

16

shift times in all

8

already worked today

8

are new — nobody works them today

The new times to learn

06:20-15:00

8h 40m · early · Saturdays

07:00-16:00

9h 00m · early · weekdays

07:15-15:30

8h 15m · early · Sundays

07:30-16:30

9h 00m · early · Saturdays

09:00-18:00

9h 00m · early · Sundays

14:30-22:30

8h 00m · late · Sundays

15:15-23:25

8h 10m · late · Sundays

15:45-23:55

8h 10m · late · weekdays

No longer used: 10 of today's 18 shift times — 06:20-13:45, 06:20-14:00, 07:15-15:45, 08:00-16:30, 08:30-16:30, 11:00-19:30, 12:00-20:00, 13:00-21:00, 13:30-22:00, 14:45-23:55.

Every shift time, beside today's

SHIFT TIME	TODAY'S LINK			PROPOSED		
	MON-FRI	SAT	SUN	MON-FRI	SAT	SUN
06:20-13:35 7h 15m · Early	1			1		
06:20-13:45 DROPPED 7h 25m · Early	1			0 (-1)		
06:20-14:00 DROPPED 7h 40m · Early		1			0 (-1)	
06:20-14:20 8h 00m · Early	2			2		
06:20-14:50 8h 30m · Early		3		2 (+2)	2 (-1)	
06:20-15:00 NEW 8h 40m · Early					3 (+3)	
07:00-16:00 NEW 9h 00m · Early				2 (+2)		
07:15-15:30 NEW 8h 15m · Early						4 (+4)
07:15-15:45 DROPPED 8h 30m · Early			3			0 (-3)
07:30-16:30 NEW 9h 00m · Early				2 (+2)		
08:00-16:30 DROPPED 8h 30m · Early	2			0 (-2)		
08:30-16:30 DROPPED 8h 00m · Early			1			0 (-1)
09:00-18:00 NEW 9h 00m · Early						1 (+1)
11:00-19:30 DROPPED 8h 30m · Late	1			0 (-1)		
12:00-20:00 DROPPED 8h 00m · Late		1			0 (-1)	
13:00-21:00 DROPPED 8h 00m · Late			1			0 (-1)
13:30-21:00 7h 30m · Late		1		1 (+1)	0 (-1)	
13:30-22:00 DROPPED 8h 30m · Late	1			0 (-1)		
14:00-22:30 8h 30m · Late	2			2	1 (+1)	
14:30-22:00 7h 30m · Late		2			2	
14:30-22:30 NEW 8h 00m · Late						2 (+2)
14:30-23:25 8h 55m · Late			3	1 (+1)		0 (-3)
14:45-23:55 DROPPED 9h 10m · Late		2			0 (-2)	
15:15-23:25 NEW 8h 10m · Late						3 (+3)
15:15-23:55 8h 40m · Late	2			0 (-2)	4 (+4)	
15:45-23:55 NEW 8h 10m · Late				3 (+3)		

People on each shift time on a Saturday, a Sunday and — under Mon-Fri — the weekday with most of that time, so Mon-Fri can add up to more than work on one day. **(+2)** and **(-1)**: more or fewer people on that time than today — a difference, not a verdict. **New**: nobody works it today. **Dropped**: worked today, not in this link.

Monday to Friday add up to 34,850 minutes of duty and Saturday 7,150 — together exactly 42,000 minutes — 35 hours for each of the 20 working weeks, the contract (a cover week counts as a full 35-hour week on top). Sunday adds 4,950, paid on top of the contracted week. 8 of the 16 shift times are new — nobody works them today.

The shape of a week

MEASURE	TODAY	PROPOSED	IN PLAIN WORDS
Rest breaks of two days or more	13 of 17	22 of 24	of all the breaks between duties
Single rest days	4 (1 beside a cover week)	2	one beside a cover week depends on where its four duties fall
Working weeks by days worked, Sunday in	1 × 3-day, 3 × 4-day, 11 × 5-day, 1 × 6-day	6 × 4-day, 14 × 5-day	cover weeks left out
Working weeks with a Sunday	8 of 16	10 of 20	the number on duty each Sunday — all overtime

People on duty, hour by hour

Today's link and the proposal, hour by hour, against the December 2026 timetable. A darker orange hour carries more of the day's trains.

How closely the floor follows the trains

Today's link

Familiar Nine

Weekdays

52.0

Saturday

65.9

Sunday

71.7

The floor follows the trains more closely than today — weekdays about half as far off, Saturday about a quarter, Sunday about two-fifths. Lower is closer; 0 is a perfect match.

People on duty in that hour — darker blue is more. Anyone on for any part of the hour counts, so a handover counts both people.

Read down each column: the most people should be under the darkest orange.

Trains — carriages arriving and leaving in that hour; darker is busier. A guide from the timetable, not passenger numbers.

Strongest rows: the floor and the trains — the two the match compares.

Monday to Friday

staffed 06:20–23:55 · a row for each different weekday

	05	06	07	08	09	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	Match
Today, Mon · Wed — all on duty		4	4	6	6	6	7	7	7	7	7	7	5	5	5	4	4	4	2	
Today, Tue · Thu · Fri — all on duty		4	4	6	6	6	7	7	8	8	8	8	6	6	6	5	5	4	2	
of whom in the ticket office		1	1	2	2	2	2	2	2	4	2	2	2	2	1	1	1	1		
of whom on the floor Mon · Wed		3	3	4	4	4	5	5	5	3	5	5	3	3	4	3	3	3	2	61.1
of whom on the floor Tue · Thu · Fri		3	3	4	4	4	5	5	6	4	6	6	4	4	5	4	4	3	2	50.1
Proposed — all on duty		5	7	7	7	7	7	7	8	10	9	7	7	7	7	7	6	6	4	
of whom in the ticket office		1	1	2	2	2	2	2	2	4	2	2	2	2	1	1	1	1		
of whom on the floor		4	6	5	5	5	5	5	6	6	7	5	5	5	6	6	5	5	4	27.7
Trains — carriages in and out	5	69	107	127	122	95	85	75	84	79	87	105	140	138	107	90	73	75	66	

Saturday

staffed 06:20–23:55

	05	06	07	08	09	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	Match
Today — all on duty		4	4	4	4	4	4	5	6	9	6	6	6	6	6	5	4	2	2	
of whom in the ticket office		1	1	2	2	2	2	2	2	4	2	2	2	2	1	1	1			
of whom on the floor		3	3	2	2	2	2	3	4	5	4	4	4	4	5	4	3	2	2	65.9
Proposed — all on duty		5	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	10	9	9	7	7	7	7	7	5	4	
of whom in the ticket office		1	1	2	2	2	2	2	2	4	2	2	2	2	1	1	1			
of whom on the floor		4	6	5	5	5	5	5	5	6	7	7	5	5	6	6	6	5	4	15.0
Trains — carriages in and out	6	24	58	75	81	92	88	77	64	68	72	84	82	67	64	79	78	62	41	

Sunday

staffed 07:15–23:25

	05	06	07	08	09	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	Match
Today — all on duty			3	4	4	4	4	4	5	8	8	5	4	4	4	4	3	3	3	
of whom in the ticket office			1	1	2	2	2	2	2	3	3	1	1	1	1	1	1	1		
of whom on the floor			2	3	2	2	2	2	3	5	5	4	3	3	3	3	2	2	3	71.7
Proposed — all on duty			4	4	5	5	5	5	5	7	10	6	6	5	5	5	5	5	3	
of whom in the ticket office			1	1	2	2	2	2	2	2	4	2	2	1	1	1	1	1		
of whom on the floor			3	3	3	3	3	3	3	5	6	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	3	26.4
Trains — carriages in and out			15	45	65	71	74	71	61	55	64	69	78	73	75	52	71	65	50	

Good to know

- The ticket office.** In the proposal, two people on every ticket-office shift, and not floor cover except at the quiet ends: Monday to Saturday one of each pair is on the floor until 08:00 and from 19:30, so the office row drops to 1 in those hours and the floor row gains one; where it shows 4, both pairs are there at the changeover. The "of whom" rows take the office out of each side, so the floor rows compare like with like.
- Sunday.** One early is on the floor until 09:00; the two lates are on the floor until 15:00, then both in the office — at least 30 minutes' handover — and one goes back to the floor from 18:00. Today one of the three 14:30–23:25 closers keeps the office until 22:30, so in the 16:00 and 17:00 hours today's office row reads 1 where the proposal's reads 2 (the 15:00 hour also counts the earlies finishing).
- Reading the match.** The weekday figure at the top is worked out from the five weekdays together, not averaged from the day scores. It measures **shape, not numbers** — each hour's share of the day's staff against its share of the day's trains — so an extra person in a quiet hour makes it worse even though nobody is worse off. Read it beside the numbers of people, never alone.
- Cover weeks.** They are not in these figures, because their times are not known yet; actual staffing depends on where those duties are used.
- Sunday's last trains.** On Sundays five trains in the December 2026 timetable arrive or leave after the 23:25 finish (the last at 23:54); the bar under the Sunday 23:00 hour marks the time after the finish. No duty runs past 23:25 on a Sunday — that is agreed practice and stays so (settled 28 Sep 2026) — so those trains fall outside the staffed day of any link, today's included.

THE RULES

Hard limits and the December 2026 rules

Three hard limits a rota must meet to be run at all, then the nine December 2026 staffing rules, each with today's link beside it.

Hard limits — met, or the rota cannot be run

MOST DAYS IN A ROW

6

✓ met · longest possible · limit 13 · today 9

Longest possible run is 6 days, within Chiltern's limit of 13. A cover week is 4 duties in 7 days and the roster clerk places them, so this is the worst case the link allows. Worked as a block of four rather than split day-on-day-off, the answer is the same — **6 days** — wherever the block falls, so this row does not depend on how a cover week is placed.
The written source of the 13-day limit is still to be confirmed.

SHORTEST REST BETWEEN SHIFTS

14h 20m

✓ met · anywhere in the link · limit 12h · today 12h 30m

Tightest anywhere: **14h 20m** — line 2 Fri 07:00-16:00 into Sat 06:20-15:00 (today's tightest: 12h 30m).

THE 35-HOUR CONTRACT

35h 00m

✓ met · a week, Monday to Saturday, on average · must be exact

700h of duty a week across 20 working lines. Sunday duties (82h 30m in all) are paid on top as rest-day working, as they are today. Individual weeks range 24h 30m-41h 45m; only the average is the contract.

The December 2026 rules

✓ 9 of 9 met

RULE	TODAY'S LINK	THIS PROPOSAL	WHAT THE RULE ASKS
At least four on at the open, every day	✗ 4 · 4 · 3	✓ 5 · 5 · 4	from 06:20 (07:15 on a Sunday)
At least three through to the close, every day	✗ 2 · 2 · 3	✓ 3 · 4 · 3	until 23:55 (23:25 on a Sunday)
At least five still on duty at 22:00, every day	✗ 4 · 2 · 3	✓ 6 · 5 · 5	someone finishing at 22:00 does not count
Ten on a Sunday	✗ 8	✓ 10	
The ticket office: two early and two late, identical shifts, every day	✗ Mon-Fri yes · Sat yes · Sun no	✓ Mon-Fri yes · Sat yes · Sun yes	Mon-Fri 06:20-14:20 and 14:00-22:30; Sat 06:20-14:50 and 14:30-22:00; Sun two from 07:15 and two to 22:30
At least two on the floor at every moment	✓ fewest 2 · 2 · 2	✓ fewest 3 · 3 · 3	the ticket office counts only while its staff help on the floor — Mon-Sat one of each pair until 08:00 and from 19:30; on a Sunday one early until 09:00, both lates until 15:00 and one from 18:00; checked every five minutes
Handovers: 15 minutes to each closer, 20 in the ticket office (30 on a Sunday)	✓ floor met · ticket office 20 min	✓ floor met · ticket office 20 min	the Sunday office handover runs from 15:00, when the lates join it; on a Sunday each opener also stays until 15 minutes after the last closer arrives; where the design does not roster the office pairs, the plan's posts are assumed
Sunday duties between 8h and 9h	✓ 8h 00m-8h 55m	✓ 8h 00m-9h 00m	
No more shift times than today	✓ 18	✓ 16	today 18

Fatigue checks

From the Office of Rail and Road's good-practice guidance, *Fatigue Factors*, page 3 (December 2021): 21 roster patterns that tend to tire people, with 4 checks from the rail industry's fatigue guidance (MRSF). ▲ present — worth a look, not a breach · ✓ clear · ● standing — comes with the station's hours or any weekly link.

AVOIDABLE FATIGUE WARNINGS

0 in the fixed duties; cover-week duties are not known yet · today's link has 5 · each is a question to discuss, not a breach

STANDING — COME WITH EVERY WEEKLY LINK

2 early starts at a 06:20 station, and a rotation that moves everyone one line a week · recorded, not counted

For each of the 25 patterns this table asks whether it is in the rotation, today and proposed, and how big it is. A design showing nothing is not thereby approved: this is guidance, not a fatigue risk assessment.

PATTERN	TODAY'S LINK	PROPOSED
Early starts, 05:00 to 06:59 FF2 · Early shift starting 05:00–07:00 · Time of day	● 24	● 30
Very early starts, before 05:00 FF3 · Very early shift starting before 05:00 · Time of day	✓ 0	✓ 0
Shifts over 12 hours FF5 · Day shift over 12h · Duty length	✓ 0	✓ 0
Early shifts over 10 hours FF7 · Early shift over 10h · Duty length	✓ 0	✓ 0
Too little rest after a run of early starts FF8b · Fewer than 2 days rest after a block of early starts · Recovery time	▲ 3	✓ 0
Too many shifts without a two-day break FF11 · More than 13 consecutive shifts without a 48h break · Recovery time	✓ 12 ✓ 9 as rostered	✓ 8 ✓ 8 as rostered
Runs of 12-hour day shifts FF10 · More than 4 consecutive 12h day shifts · Cumulative	✓ 0	✓ 0
Long runs of early shifts FF15 · More than 4 consecutive early shifts in a rotating pattern · Cumulative	▲ 6	✓ 4
Long runs of day shifts MRSF · More than 12 consecutive day shifts · Cumulative	✓ 9	✓ 6
More than 55 hours in a week MRSF · More than 55 hours worked in any 7-day period · Cumulative	▲ 60.8	✓ 51.3
Long runs of 8-hour shifts MRSF · More than 7 consecutive 8h shifts · Cumulative	▲ 9	✓ 6
Start times moving earlier through the week FF17 · Backward rotating pattern · Circadian	✓ 10 backward / 12 forward	✓ 12 backward / 12 forward
Changing shift type about once a week FF18 · Rotating pattern of about a week · Circadian	● 20-line rotation · typically 4h 00m a week	● 24-line rotation · typically 1h 44m a week
Start times that jump by more than two hours FF19 · Successive start times varying by more than 2 hours · (definition to confirm) · Circadian	▲ 6	✓ 0
Less than 12 hours between two shifts FF13 · Less than 12h rest in any 24h · Intervals between duties	✓ 0	✓ 0

Also on the list, and applying to neither link: time of day (FF1) · duty length (FF4) · cumulative (MRSF) · night shifts (FF6, FF8, FF9, FF12, FF14, FF16, FF20).

- **Standing factors (●) are recorded for information, not counted.** FF2 comes with the station's 06:20 open, and FF18 — the ORR's concern with a rotation that changes shift type about once a week (Managing rail staff fatigue, 7.68) — comes with every weekly link, which moves everyone one line a week by construction; its week-to-week step is shown as information.
- **How to read the table.** The figure beside each mark is the worst case found, for today's link as for the proposal, except where a row counts only the duties the rota fixes: the 55-hour row counts a cover week as no hours, and FF8b counts none of its days as early. "As rostered" under FF11 is the worst of the places a cover week's four duties could fall when worked together, which is usual. The MRSF rows are extra checks from the rail industry's guidance on managing staff fatigue, listed beside the ORR's own. FF2 and FF15 use the ORR's early — a start from 05:00 up to 06:59, not the 11:00 used elsewhere on this sheet; the station opens at 06:20, so every link has FF2. FF11 counts shifts between two-day breaks, so a single rest day does not reset it — that is why it can be longer than the most days worked in a row.
- **Cover weeks.** A cover week's four duties can fall in different ways, and on this design that moves the run of 8-hour shifts (5 if placed well). Where they fall is for the roster office. This page is an aid to discussion, not a fatigue risk assessment.

Can I trust these numbers?

How firm each figure is, what it is based on, and what no rota can tell you.

Firm

Worked out exactly from the rota, and checked again by the app:

- the rest gaps and the most days in a row
- the 35-hour contract
- full weekends off
- how many people are on duty, hour by hour
- the shift times and their lengths

A guide, not a verdict

Useful for comparing, never a pass or a fail:

- how closely staff follow the trains
- the fatigue warnings — guidance from the rail regulator
- how familiar the shift times are
- figures “each, a year” — averages over the whole link

Not known yet

No rota can say these; they are for the people who work it and the managers who roster it:

- where each cover week’s four duties fall
- how leave and sickness land
- whether staff accept the new shift times
- Wembley event days — the rota follows the trains, not the crowds
- who starts on which line
- the written source of the 13-day limit

What each figure is based on

Where the figures come from

Every figure is worked out from the rota on page 3 by the Marylebone Roster app, and the same calculation is run on today’s link. None is typed in by hand.

Cover weeks

Marked on all seven days but worked on four, placed by the roster clerk. A cover week counts as a full contracted week and as four days at work. Where a figure depends on where the four fall, the worst case is shown — except three fatigue rows, set out on page 7: the 55-hour row counts a cover week as no hours, FF8b counts none of its days as early, and FF11 “as rostered” takes the four worked together. Their shift times are not known yet, so yearly counts and rest gaps cover the fixed duties only; whatever is later given in a cover week must still be rostered within the normal limits.

Sundays

Sunday is not in the contract: Sunday duties are overtime, as today. So “days at work” and the 35-hour week are Monday to Saturday. A Sunday off costs no annual leave.

Each person, a year

Every week’s duties, times 52, shared across everyone on the link — Sunday overtime included. “Days at work a year” is Monday to Saturday only: the days a week $\times 365 \div 7$. Somebody’s own year depends on which week they start on.

Following the trains

For each hour, the share of the day’s floor staff is set against the share of the day’s train service in the December 2026 timetable, each train weighted by its length; the differences are squared — so one big mismatch counts far more than several small ones — added up and multiplied by 10,000. 0 would be a perfect match; lower is closer. The staff share uses the minutes each person spends on the floor, finer than the whole-person counts on page 5, where anyone on for part of an hour counts. It measures the shape of the day, not a staffing level: an extra person in a quiet hour makes it worse although nobody is worse off. The ticket office is taken out first: it is staffed to its opening hours, not to the trains, which is why its rows on page 5 carry no match figure.

The ticket office

In the proposal, two people on every ticket-office shift, not floor cover except at the quiet ends: Monday to Saturday one of each pair is on the floor until 08:00 and from 19:30. On a Sunday one early is on the floor until 09:00; the two lates until 15:00, then both in the office, one back on the floor from 18:00. Today one person keeps the office on a Sunday afternoon and evening.

Rest, runs and weekends

The shortest gap is the single tightest one anywhere, Saturday into Sunday and line into line included. The most days in a row counts Sunday overtime too, with a cover week placed as badly as it can be. A full weekend off is a Saturday off then a Sunday off. The shortest gap is one gap: a rota with many rests of just over 12 hours reads the same as one with none.

Handover

The overlap when one shift takes over from another. The December rules ask for 15 minutes to each closer, and 20 in the ticket office (30 on a Sunday) — page 6.

Familiar shift times

How many of the shift times somebody already works today — a rough guide to how much there is to learn, not to what staff will accept.

Fatigue warnings

The Office of Rail and Road’s good-practice list of roster patterns that tend to tire people, with four rail-industry checks. A warning is a question to discuss, not a breach, and this is not a fatigue risk assessment. Early starts at a 06:20 station and a weekly rotation come with every link, today’s included, so they are recorded on page 7 and not counted. In the ORR’s checks an early start is one from 05:00 up to 06:59 and a “block” of earlies is two or more in a row; the start-time rows count how many times a start moves by more than two hours (a count, not hours); the week-to-week move is the average change in a week’s mean start time, Sundays included and cover weeks left out.

What is confirmed

The December 2026 staffing levels, a 24-person link and the Sunday cover were confirmed verbally on 29 September 2026.

The rota is supplied beside this PDF as Familiar-Nine-F9-24-K31s-import.txt, ready to paste into the Links page (Import), which re-runs every check here. The code **598a1294** in every footer is worked out from the 168 days of the rota and nothing else, so a printout always matches the design it came from.